MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Infrastructure | QA Automation Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA Automation Engineer with 7 years of experience, including 2+ years focused on CI/CD pipelines, ephemeral test environments and build tooling; owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and has improved pipeline speed and test reliability, reducing average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes. Builds test environments with Docker and Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster, with personal hands-on experience in k3s, GitOps, observability and Terraform, and is transitioning into DevOps and platform infrastructure.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Argo CD
Infrastructure as Code & Automation: Terraform (personal Hetzner project), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python
Observability & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems & Cloud: Linux, AWS: EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)
Other: Git, Java (test code)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) *2021–Present*
Odrava Health Software | Wrocław

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing. Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests; monthly CI runner costs decreased by approximately 30%.
- Built per-merge-request ephemeral test environments using Docker Compose and Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster, enabling QA and product teams to review features before merge; environments included the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data and were automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%. Built a Python and PostgreSQL test-results pipeline and Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored the internal “How Our CI Works” guide, now used in team onboarding. Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer *2019–2021*
Brightmill Software House | Wrocław

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.

- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps *2024–2025*
Personal

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, and Traefik ingress with cert-manager-managed TLS certificates.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BEng, Computer Engineering 2018
Silesian Lowlands University of Technology

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation | Exam scheduled for January 2027